STEVEN FOSTER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Power BI Analytics Engineer with 9+ years of experience building enterprise semantic models and reporting, with a focus on treating semantic models as code. Develops models in TMDL and Power BI Projects (PBIP) under Git source control in GitHub, automates modeling standards with Tabular Editor C# scripts, and validates every change with Best Practice Analyzer and a custom Model Linter before release. Prepares semantic models for AI by documenting every table, column, and measure with clear descriptions, hiding technical fields, and preparing synonyms, so models are ready for Copilot and other AI tools. Strong foundation in DAX, advanced Power Query (M), performance optimization, SQL, Azure Data Factory, Databricks, Python, and data governance.

CORE SKILLS

Semantic Models as Code: TMDL, Power BI Projects (PBIP/PBIR), Tabular Editor 3, C# Scripting, Best Practice Analyzer (BPA), Model Linter, Model Automation

Version Control & Quality: Git, GitHub, TMDL Diffs & Change History, Pre-Release Model Validation, Modeling Standards & Best Practices

AI-Ready Semantic Models: Table, Column & Measure Descriptions, Synonym Preparation, Hidden Technical Fields, Copilot Readiness, Power BI Modeling MCP

Power BI: Power BI Desktop, Power BI Service, Semantic Models, DAX, Power Query (M), Calculation Groups, Incremental Refresh, Dataflows, Row-Level Security (RLS)

Modeling & Performance: Semantic Data Modeling, DAX Optimization, DAX Studio, VertiPaq Analyzer, Model Optimization, Performance Tuning

Data Engineering: SQL, T-SQL, ETL/ELT, Data Warehousing, Azure Data Factory, Databricks, Python

Analytics & Delivery: KPI Development, Executive Reporting, Dashboard Design, Requirements Gathering, Stakeholder Engagement, Data Governance, Mentoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Analytics Engineer | Equus Workforce Solutions | Louisville, KY (Remote) | March 2025 – Present

- Design and maintain enterprise Power BI semantic models and reporting solutions that provide trusted analytics across multiple functional areas.
- Manage semantic models as code using TMDL and Power BI Projects (PBIP) in GitHub, giving every model readable diffs and a full change history.
- Validate every model change against Tabular Editor Best Practice Analyzer rules and the Model Linter from the SF Power BI Toolkit before release, catching modeling, naming, and performance issues early.
- Develop a library of Tabular Editor C# scripts that apply modeling standards in one pass: hiding key columns on the many side of relationships, organizing measures, columns, and calculated columns into display subfolders, formatting DAX and Power Query code, applying short-date and data-type format strings, and removing default summarization from all columns.
- Prepare semantic models for AI by using the SF Power BI Toolkit to write descriptions for every table, column, and measure and to generate synonyms, so models are ready for Copilot once Premium or Fabric capacity is available.
- Optimize SQL queries, DAX measures, semantic models, and advanced Power Query (M) transformations, including reusable functions that standardize data preparation, to improve performance, scalability, and accuracy.
- Implement scalable data pipelines, ETL/ELT processes, and data warehouse solutions using Azure Data Factory, Databricks, and other Azure services.
- Implement Power BI data governance standards, row-level security (RLS), and data quality validation processes to support trusted and secure reporting.
- Develop Python automation to prepare, validate, and restructure Excel-based data sources before ingestion into Power BI, reducing manual preparation and improving data quality.
- Partner with stakeholders to define KPIs, measurement strategies, and reporting requirements and translate them into scalable analytics solutions.

Data Visualization Specialist | BrightSpring Health Services | Louisville, KY (Remote) | February 2022 – March 2025

- Designed, developed, and optimized enterprise Power BI solutions, including semantic models, reports, and visualizations supporting executive and operational decision-making.

- Optimized a large Power BI semantic model, achieving performance improvements of up to 75% and significantly improving the responsiveness of reporting solutions.
- Designed advanced semantic models using DAX, Power Query (M), calculation groups, and other Power BI modeling capabilities to support robust enterprise analytics.
- Used Tabular Editor 3 for semantic model development and maintenance, and trained other BI developers to use it, spreading consistent modeling practices across the team.
- Promoted semantic models and reports through development, test, and production stages using Power BI deployment pipelines on Premium capacity.
- Developed interactive Power BI reports that transformed complex data into clear, actionable analytics for senior stakeholders.
- Established data governance standards and row-level security (RLS) policies to support data integrity and secure reporting.
- Mentored junior BI developers and promoted Power BI development best practices across the analytics team.

Senior Business Intelligence Analyst | Staples | Florence, KY | August 2019 – February 2022

- Led the transition from MicroStrategy to Power BI, supporting the modernization of the enterprise reporting environment.
- Led Power BI data modeling and visualization initiatives that improved reporting efficiency and stakeholder engagement.
- Established a standardized report repository that improved report consistency and reduced report development time by up to 50%.
- Designed advanced data models and optimized SQL queries and DAX calculations to improve dashboard performance and end-user experience.
- Mentored junior BI developers and promoted consistent reporting standards and development practices across the team.

Business Intelligence Analyst | Staples | Florence, KY | January 2017 – August 2019

- Developed enterprise reporting solutions using Power BI and MicroStrategy to support operational and business analysis.
- Supported the transition from MicroStrategy to Power BI through report development, data modeling, and visualization.
- Established standardized reporting assets and repository practices that improved consistency and reduced report development time.
- Built scalable reporting solutions that enhanced data governance and centralized reporting practices.

SELECTED PROJECTS

SF Power BI Toolkit (Foster BI Services): Free browser-based tools for designing reports, shaping data, building semantic models, checking them with a Model Linter, and documenting them, with nothing to install and no data uploaded. Built for teams where Copilot is the only approved AI tool. fosterbiservices.github.io/Power-BI-Toolkit

Power BI Portfolio (GitHub): Public portfolio of Power BI reports and semantic models maintained in Git, including an interactive Power BI version of this résumé.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Power BI & Microsoft Fabric: Power BI Desktop, Power BI Service, Power BI Premium, Deployment Pipelines, Power BI Report Server, Dataflows, Semantic Models, Incremental Refresh, Row-Level Security (RLS)

Modeling & DAX: DAX, Advanced Data Modeling, Calculation Groups, DAX Query Development, DAX Studio, VertiPaq Analyzer, Semantic Model QA and Validation

Model Development & Version Control: TMDL, PBIP/PBIR, Tabular Editor 3, C# Scripting, Best Practice Analyzer, Model Linter, Git, GitHub

AI Readiness: Metadata Descriptions, Synonyms, Hidden Technical Fields, Copilot Readiness, SF Power BI Toolkit

Data & Engineering: SQL, T-SQL, Data Warehousing, Data Integration, Data Quality, Data Governance, Azure Data Factory, Databricks

Programming & Automation: Python, C#, DAX, Power Query (M)

BI & Office: MicroStrategy, Advanced Excel, PowerPoint, Word

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

MicroStrategy World 2018 Dossier Contest Winner
Recognized for excellence in dashboard design and data visualization at the annual MicroStrategy global conference.